

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Insignia Committee, NSDAR

Do you have a question about Insignia? Start here!

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Ordering Pins

Q. I am a new DAR member. How do I order pins?

A. DAR Insignia and pins can be ordered from the DAR Insignia Store at:
<http://shop.dar.org/dar-insignia-store/>.



Q. I would like to purchase service pins for state-level service (e.g.: State Chair of the State Conference Credentials Committee) earned under three past State Regents. Do I need signatures of all the past State Regents?

A. Your current state regent can sign for all three. Here is a link to the [oval State Chair pin](#).



Q. Is there a past state officer pin?

A. There is not a past state officer pin. When the [State Officer pin](#) is ordered, the years of service are engraved on it. You can continue to wear your [State Officer pin](#) on your ribbon, placing it according to the official placement of pins.



Q. Is there an Associate Member pin?

A. Yes, there is an [Associate Member pin](#). You can also order an [engraved bar](#) for each chapter of which you are an associate member.



Q. I would like to become an associate member of an overseas chapter. What pin would I be eligible to wear?

A. Associate members of a Units Overseas chapters are eligible to wear the [Units Overseas pin](#) with [a bar engraved with the name of the country](#) (e.g., “Italy”). If you are an associate member of multiple Unites Overseas, you may order [engraved bars for each country](#) (e.g., “Mexico,” “England,” “Japan,” etc.)



Q. I understand that there are two different state chair pins, the one with the eagle and the oval one. What is the difference?

A. The State Chair pin with the eagle on the top is for state chairs of National Committees. The [oval State Chair pin](#) is for state chairs of state standing, special and state conference committees.

Q. If “Jane” makes a donation to a project fund in honor of “Mary” and specifies on the form that the credit goes to “Mary,” can “Jane” also buy the pin?

A. No. Only one person would be eligible to buy the pin. Since “Mary” was specified on the form to receive the credit, she would be the only one eligible to buy the pin.



Q. How soon after taking office, can a new state officer or state chair order her pin for that position?

A. A new state chair or new state officer may order her pin(s) after she is elected as a new state officer or appointed as a state chair.



Q. What is a “Best Friend” pin?

A. The [Best Friend pin](#) is earned through a donation to a “Friends Fund.” The average amount is \$100 or \$200. These various funds are listed in the DAR Handbook (or from the DAR Development Office). Upon receipt of an additional donation equal to the minimum required donation to the same Friends Fund, you would then be eligible to purchase the [Best Friend pin](#) and corresponding [engraved bar](#). The bar will be engraved with that Friends Fund name (e.g., American History). There is no limit to the number of contributions or bars that can be added. The President General’s Project and Benefactor pins are not in the Best Friends category.



Q. What is engraved on the Member-for-Member pin?

A. The [Member-for-Member pin](#)’s [bar is engraved](#) with the number (in increments of five) of new members credited. The DAR Handbook states, “When the prospective member becomes a DAR member, the Office of the Registrar General records the sponsoring member’s Member-for-Member credit, and she is then eligible to purchase the Member-for-Member pin to wear on their official DAR ribbon. The member is eligible to purchase one member-for-Member bar for every five additional new members credited after she has earned her Member-for-Member pin. The bar easily attaches to the pin.”



Q. The chapter donated \$100 to the Friends of Veterans fund in my honor. Can I buy the [Friends of Veterans pin](#) to wear on my ribbon?
A. Since the chapter donated the money for the contribution in your honor, the chapter would have to order the pin. Then, you could pay the chapter for the pin.

Chapter Pins



Q. What is the requirement to purchase a Charter Chapter Member pin and bar?

A. A member is eligible to purchase a [Charter Chapter Member pin with Organizing Bar](#) if she was an organizing member at the time the chapter was organized. A member is eligible for a [Charter Chapter Member pin](#) if she was admitted, transferred or reinstated into the chapter during the first year following the chapter's organization date.



Q. If I transfer my membership to another chapter can I wear chapter bars from the old chapter and the new chapter?

A. Yes, the new [chapter bar](#) should be worn above the old chapter bar.

Chapter Regent



Q. I am now a chapter regent and was presented with the Chapter Regent pin on a ribbon with insignia. May I take off the Chapter Regent's pin and wear it on my own ribbon?

A. If the [Chapter Regent's pin](#) is on a ribbon with an insignia, then she usually wears this during her term of office, much like the State Regents do. However, if she is only presented with the [Chapter Regent's pin](#) and no ribbon, she may place the Chapter Regents Pin according order found in on the [Pin Placement guide, Form INS-1000](#). At the end of her term, the pin is returned to the chapter.



Q. The chapter has an Ex-Chapter Regent pin. There is now a Past Chapter Regent pin. Which is correct or does it matter?

A. The Ex-Chapter Regent pin is the older version. [Past Chapter Regent](#) is the newer pin now being sold. However, the Ex-Chapter Regent pin may still be worn on the ribbon.



Q. If a past chapter regent has a Past Chapter Regent pin and an Honorary Chapter Regent pin, can she wear both on her ribbon?

A. Yes, the [Honorary Chapter Regent pin](#) goes above the [Past Chapter Regent pin](#).

Q. When a chapter regent has served a second term, but not concurrently, does the chapter present her with another Past Chapter Regent's pin?

A. If the chapter wishes to do so, they may. However, since she already has a [Past Chapter Regent's pin](#), they could present her with a commemorative pin or contribution pin for her ribbon.

Q. When you are chapter regent, can you wear the Chapter Regent's pin with ribbon and insignia next to your own ribbon and pins?

A. No, only one [official insignia](#) may be worn at a time.

Q. Can a donation pin or a commemorative pin, purchased by the chapter, be worn on the chapter regent's ribbon?

A. Yes, if the chapter makes the donation to a DAR fund and purchases the pin, it may be worn on the chapter regent's ribbon. Since the pin belongs to the chapter, it remains on the ribbon when the ribbon is passed to the next chapter regent.



Q When a member transfers to another chapter, can she continue wearing the Past Chapter Regent pin from her former chapter?

A. Yes, she would continue wearing the [Past Chapter Regent pin](#) since she held that office. If she becomes a Past Chapter Regent of her current chapter, that pin would be worn above the other pin.

Q. I am a past chapter regent, and now a Past Chapter Regent again, in another chapter. Can I wear both pins?

A. Yes, the [Past Chapter Regent pin](#) of the current chapter would be placed above the [Past Chapter Regent pin](#) from your previous chapter.

Chapter Officer



Q. I recently received my Chapter Officer pin. It has two small rings at the bottom. Is this something new with the Chapter Officer pin?

A. Yes, the [Chapter Officer pin](#) now comes with loops to attach [engraved bars](#). The bars are [engraved with the chapter office](#) and attached in order of service.

Q. I am a past chapter regent; can I still wear a Chapter Officer pin with bars on my ribbon?

A. Yes, you may wear the [Chapter Officer pin](#) with [engraved bars for each chapter office](#) under your [Past Chapter Regent pin](#).

Q. I am no longer treasurer of our chapter. Can I still wear my chapter officer pin?

A. Yes, you may continue to wear your [Chapter Officer pin](#) since you held a chapter office.

Ancestor Pins



Q. What is the difference between the Ancestor Bar and the Ancestor Rider?

A. The [Ancestor Bar](#) has a pin back behind it. The Ancestor Rider has a thin wire behind it with no pin. If you have a single ribbon (not padded), the Ancestor Rider slides down the ribbon. If you have your pins on a padded ribbon set, you'll need an ancestor bar with the pin back.

Q. Can a state pin be worn for the state where your ancestor or supplemental ancestors served?

A. Yes.



Q. My supplemental ancestors are not all from the same state. How do you place them with the state pins?

A. The state pins are grouped together above the [Ancestor Bars](#). The [Ancestor Bars](#) are grouped together below the state pins.

Q. I have two supplemental ancestors who served in the same state. Can I wear two pins from the same state?

A. One state pin should represent the two ancestors.

Q. My ancestor served in two states during the Revolutionary War. Can I wear both state pins or just one?

A. If you have previously proven his service in both states, then yes, you may wear both state pins. When an order is received, your ancestor's service will be verified on your member record.



Q. Can I wear the State CENTENNIAL pin for the state of my ancestor and supplemental ancestors?

A. No, a State Centennial pin may only be worn for the state where you hold membership (not associate membership), not for the state of your ancestor and not for the state of supplemental ancestors.



Q. Can Ancestor Bars be buffed and re-engraved? How about other pins?

A. The [Ancestor Bars](#) and [Chapter Bars](#) currently available for sale in the [DAR Insignia Store](#) cannot be re-engraved since they are thin and deeply engraved.

Wearing Pins



Q. What is the difference between the Recognition Pin and the Miniature pin?

A. The Recognition pin (small plain insignia) is worn on the lapel. The [Miniature insignia](#) (plain or pierced) is worn on the miniature, narrow ribbon. Also, the [Miniature Insignia](#) may be worn on a branch bar along with miniatures from other societies. Another way to remember—the recognition pin has the pin closure and the miniature has the loop. The recognition and branch bar may be worn on any occasion. The

Recognition pin is not to be placed on the official ribbon with other pins. The [Miniature Insignia](#) on narrow ribbon is to be worn at DAR functions as you would the official ribbon and pins.

Q. Can I put DAR pins on the miniature narrow ribbon with the miniature insignia?

A. No other pins are to be placed on the [Miniature Insignia](#)'s narrow ribbon, only the [Miniature Insignia](#) at the end of the ribbon.



Q. The “Placement of DAR Insignia and Pins on Official Ribbon” says, place pins “beginning with the highest office at the top of the ribbon.” Is it the highest office that I am currently serving or the highest office held?

A. Please refer to the [Pin Placement guide, Form INS-1000](#), for the current placement of all DAR pins on the official ribbon.

Q. I don’t have a service pin, a “highest office held,” i.e. Past Chapter Regent’s pin. What do I wear at the top of my ribbon?

A. Please refer to the [Pin Placement guide, Form INS-1000](#), for the current placement of all DAR pins on the official ribbon.

Q. My ribbon has three rows. How do I go from one row to the next?

A. You begin with the outside row closest to your arm starting at the top of the ribbon according to the [Pin Placement guide, Form INS-1000](#). The second row starts at the top and goes down. The third row (closest to your neck) starts at the top and ends with the DAR Insignia at the bottom.

Q. I recently joined DAR, and I’ve purchased an official Insignia pin. May I wear the pin alone, without the ribbon and ancestor bar?

A. The [Insignia](#) may not be worn by itself as a pin. The [official insignia](#) is to be worn at the bottom of the [official ribbon](#). You may purchase the Recognition pin to wear on its own.

Q. Can commemorative and donation pins be worn off the official ribbon?

A. Yes, in June 2023, the Executive Committee ruled that members may wear official NSDAR commemorative and donation pins off of the official ribbon. The pins shall be worn individually as a brooch and not attached to a right-side ribbon. Please refer to the Pin Requirements Form (INS-WP-1001) at www.dar.org/pinrequirements for the donation pin requirements. Commemorative pins may be worn by anyone; there is no service or donation requirement.

Q. In what order do I put pins on my ribbon?

A. The [“Placement of DAR Insignia and Pins on Official Ribbon”](#) is the official order to follow.

Q. Can I wear a State Regent’s project pin on my official ribbon?

A. No, only pins approved by the National Board of Management may be worn on the official ribbon. Other pins such as State Regent’s Project, Cameo Club, DAR campaign pins, etc., may be worn on the lapel or on a separate unofficial right-side ribbon.

Q. Can I wear the Cameo Club pin on the official ribbon?

A. No, a Cameo Club pin can either be worn on the lapel, dress or on a separate, unofficial right-side ribbon, along with other non-official DAR related-pins.

Q. Can I wear my DAR ribbon and pins to the funeral or calling hours of a DAR member?

A. Yes.

Q. Can I wear the miniature “branch” pin and my official DAR ribbon and insignia at the same time?

A. You should wear one or the other, not both, at the same time.



Q. Can a member wear a President General's project pin that belonged to someone else?

A. A member may wear the President General's Project donor pin on her official ribbon after she has contributed the specified amount to the President General's Project. Please contact the DAR Development Office to make a donate at (800) 449-1776 or development@DAR.org.

Q. When I wear my ribbon and pins, can I wear another pin on my left lapel?

A. Only a United States Flag pin.

Q. The local genealogical library is holding a day-long seminar for people interested in joining hereditary societies. I am representing DAR, giving the lecture on how to fill out the application and join DAR. Can I wear my pins?

A. Yes, you may wear your pins since you are representing DAR at the seminar. If you were just attending the seminar (and not representing DAR), the answer would be no.

Q. Can I wear my DAR ribbon and pins to an SAR meeting?

A. Only if you are representing DAR at the function, such as bringing greetings on behalf of a DAR State Society or Chapter. If not, you may wear the DAR Recognition pin.

Q. If I give my pins to a family member who belongs to DAR, can she wear them?

A. She can wear the insignia and any of the commemorative pins. However, she can only wear the service and donation pins which she is eligible to wear.

Q. Can a deceased member wear her pins during her funeral service? Can she be buried wearing her pins?

A. Yes, to both questions; it is allowable. However, members usually leave their pins to the family, their chapter or NSDAR. Please contact the DAR Insignia Store for information about donating pins.

Q. I am a member of a chapter and soon will be moving and transferring my membership to another chapter. Can I still wear my state pin and my chapter centennial pin from my original chapter?

A. Yes. You may continue to wear the state pin and chapter centennial pin since you were a member of that chapter when they were purchased, therefore are eligible to wear them.



Q. What are the requirements for wearing the "Serving the Nation" pin?

A. To be eligible to purchase and wear the [Serving the Nation pin](#), a member must have served in the United States military, in the National Guard or in the State Guard if they are subject to deployment or if they received the DD214 Honorable Discharge when leaving the service. Proof of service must be submitted with [Serving the Nation pin](#) order.

Documents supporting this service are shredded by NSDAR to ensure privacy.



Q. If a member joins a DAR social club, buys and wears the pin, can she continue to wear the pin if she is no longer a member of the club?

A. Yes, she may continue to wear the pin since she was a member when it was purchased.

Q. At Congress I saw a member wearing a pin scarf, that she wore around her neck with the official DAR pins on the left and other DAR-related pins on the right. Is this pin scarf legal?

A. Absolutely and positively NOT. The DAR Handbook says that the official insignia is to be worn over the left breast and should conform to the dignity of the DAR which it represents.



Q. I can't find the Veteran Patients Committee pin on the official list of pins?

A. The name of the committee was changed to DAR Service for Veterans. To wear the [Service for Veterans Pin](#) on your official ribbon, you have to be appointment as a representative or deputy representative to Veterans Affairs Voluntary Service (VAVS). You must also attend three VAVS meetings a year.



Q. Is there a pin for participating in the Descendants Project?

A. The Descendants Project, and other projects, are now under the DAR Records Preservation Committee. There is a [DAR Genealogy Preservation pin](#) available at this time.

Q. Can I wear the official pins of other patriotic organizations with my DAR official ribbon and pins at DAR functions?

A. No, only the [DAR official ribbon](#) and pins are to be worn at DAR functions.

Q. Can I wear DAR pins on the miniature ribbon?

A. No, the [Miniature Insignia](#) (and its ribbon) are worn alone without other pins.

Q. What if my highest office doesn't have a slide wire so that it can be worn at the top of my pins?

A. You would wear the highest "anchor pin" at the top. If you have none, put the Chapter Bar or (next) the [Ancestor Bar](#) at the top. A ribbon bar is another solution and may be purchased and attached to the back of the ribbon.



Q. Can an associate member who lives out of state purchase that state pin?

A. Yes, an associate member is eligible to purchase the state pin(s) for the state(s) in which she is an associate member of a chapter. She is also eligible for the [Associate Member pin](#) and bar with [chapter name engraved](#).

Q. May we wear our official pins and ribbons at a DAR meeting where wine is served?

A. Yes, DAR pins may be worn at DAR function a DAR function where wine is being served. However, DAR pins should not to be worn in a bar or cocktail lounge where there is no DAR function taking place.

Q. I am in the Foreign Service. Am I eligible to purchase and wear the ["DAR Serving the Nation" pin](#)?

A. Ruling adopted by the NBM, October 1985 "...the DAR Serving the Nation Pin is to be worn either as a lapel pin or on the official ribbon below Veteran-Patients Committee Pin. Those members eligible to wear this pin shall be those who are serving or who have served in any branch of the Armed Forces of the United States." Therefore, the Foreign Service, USO and Red Cross are outside the scope of eligibility.

Q. Can I wear a "Wounded Warrior" pin purchased outside of DAR on the official ribbon?

A. No, only official DAR pins go on the [official ribbon](#) worn on the left. However, you may wear it on an unofficial badge that some members wear on the right side.



Q. I am a state chair and wear that pin. Am I allowed to wear it after I complete my term? If so, does its placement move?

A. You may continue to wear your State Chair pin when you complete your term. Its placement on your ribbon is in accordance with ["Placement of DAR Insignia and Pins on Official Ribbon"](#).

Q. Can I wear my official ribbon and pins on the left and the miniature ribbon on the right side?

A. No, you may wear **either** the [official ribbon](#) or the [Miniature Insignia](#), but not both at the same time.



Q. How do I earn a commemorative pin, i.e., Treaty of Paris or WWII?

A. There is no requirement to purchase and wear [commemorative pins](#) on your [official ribbon](#) only.

Q. Is the Parliamentarian allowed to wear her official pins and insignia at a chapter or board meeting?

A. The only time that the Parliamentarian does not wear her official pins and ribbon is when she is actually serving as Parliamentarian in a meeting. When she is NOT serving as Parliamentarian, i.e., at other events, luncheons, dinners, etc., it is perfectly fine for her to wear her insignia and pins.

Q. We are dressing in colonial costume at our State Conference. Can the State Regent wear her insignia and sash on her costume?

A. No, DAR guidelines do not make an exception for wearing the official ribbons and pins with any costume.

Q. I just purchased a pin from C.A.R. to raise money for a historical project. Can I wear this on my official DAR ribbon?

A. Since this is not an [official DAR pin](#) approved by the National Board of Management, it may not be worn on the [official ribbon](#).

Use of the DAR Insignia and Miscellaneous

Q. May I use the DAR Insignia on a chapter tote bag?

A. No, the official DAR Insignia may not be used on a tote bag. The DAR logo may be used. [Click here information about using the DAR logo and DAR's branding guidelines.](#)

Q. Can I use the DAR Insignia on business cards?

A. Yes, the DAR Insignia may be used on business cards if they are being used for official business of DAR. The DAR Handbook states, "The Insignia should appear in either the top center or upper left corner with no words written or printed above it." [Click here for additional guidance.](#)

Q. Other than the Insignia Committee web page, are there other sources of information about DAR pins?

A. Yes, the [DAR Handbook](#) and [National Information Packet](#) – Insignia Committee.



Q. Where can I purchase a DAR Banner (Flag)?

A. All DAR Banners (to be used as a DAR Banner with the American flag) are ordered directly from the [DAR Store](#) at National Headquarters. This includes all DAR Banner and a custom-made chapter banner. Custom banners used in parades may not use the insignia. The [DAR Logo](#) may be used on a parade banner.

Q. My mother would like a DAR Insignia on her headstone. She resigned from DAR. Can she still have the Insignia on her headstone?

A. Yes, your mother may have the insignia on her headstone. All that is required is that she was DAR member.

Q. A deceased member left her pins to our chapter. What should we do with them?

A. The chapter may sell the pins, at a fair price, to chapter members who are eligible to wear them. The money could go toward a favorite DAR project of the deceased member. Also, it would have "friendship value" to own a pin that had belonged to a chapter member. If there are pins not sold, they could be donated to NSDAR for resale to DAR members.

Q. Should DAR pins be sold on eBay?

A. NSDAR cannot prevent anyone from selling previously owned DAR pins on online auction websites. It is not illegal for the previous owners or dealers to sell DAR pins.

Although DAR does not purchase previously owned pins, DAR members are welcome to donate previously owned pins NSDAR for resale at a reduced price to DAR members.

Due to the increased popularity of online auction website such as eBay, DAR created an Internet Monitoring Group under the National Insignia Committee. These DAR members are appointed by the President General and share the daily responsibility of monitoring eBay and other public online auction sites. They gather the information that sellers post about DAR pins and DAR memorabilia, and using e-Membership, they inform chapters and individual DAR members about these items. Those interested have the option to purchase. It is the responsibility of the members to only purchase pins that they are eligible to wear.

Please see the ["Sample Letter for Disposal of Insignia and Pins"](#) to plan for the future of your pins.



Q. Our chapter would like to create a chapter logo to use on our Web page, name badges and other correspondence. Is this allowed?

A. No, to preserve the DAR brand, chapters and states shall use the official [DAR Logo](#) and the DAR Insignia. October 2010, the Executive Committee ruled that chapters and states shall not develop a unique logo to be used for publicity or creation of badges and pins. [Click here to view DAR's Brand Identity and Logo Style Guide](#).

Q. Our chapter would like to use the DAR Logo on some items, as a fund-raiser. We would sell to other DAR members. Is this allowed?

A. Please refer to the members only website for the most current information about use of the [DAR Logo](#) on products.

Q. Can our chapter have a special chapter pin made by the official jeweler? Would it have to be approved by National? Could we wear it on our official ribbon?

A. You may certainly have a special chapter pin made. However, it cannot be worn on the [official ribbon](#) *unless it is approved by the NBOM as an official pin for the DAR ribbon*. If not approved, a pin may be worn on the lapel or on an unofficial badge on the right side. This pin would not require National Board approval since it would not be worn on the [DAR official ribbon](#).

Q. Can a C.A.R. member wear her C.A.R. ribbon and pins while on duty paging for DAR?

A. If a C.A.R. member is paging at a DAR function, she should not wear her official C.A.R. ribbon and pins because she is serving DAR. However, if she is also a C.A.R. Debutante at a DAR State Conference she may wear her official C.A.R. ribbon and pins during the debutante presentation.

Q. If a C.A.R. member at age 18 joins DAR and maintains dual membership through age 21, can she wear both C.A.R. and DAR ribbons and pins at a DAR function?

A. No, she should only wear her DAR ribbon and pins at a DAR function.

Q. Can the DAR Insignia be used in an obituary?

A. No, according to the uses of the Insignia as stated in the DAR Handbook.

Q. My mother is deceased. Can I purchase her 25-year pin?

A. No, a years-of-service pin may not be ordered by an inactive member or for a deceased member. However, a 25-year certificate may be ordered from the Office of the Organizing Secretary General.

Q. Can our State Society use a photograph of its state pin on our DAR State Web site?

A. Yes.

Q. Can our State Society use a photograph of its state pin on the front of note cards?

A. Yes, when using note cards for DAR purposes.

Q. We are going to have a display of our chapter's history in the local historical museum. May we display a DAR Insignia and ribbon in the display case? And can we use the DAR Insignia on promotional materials for the museum?

A. Yes, you may display the DAR Insignia and ribbon, respectfully, in a display case. However, the [DAR Logo](#), not the Insignia, should be used on all promotional material.